

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 7 · CONFLICT

Reading

B1+/B2

The Fence Between Us · Two Sides of the Story

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What kind of conflict do you think this story is about?

2. Have you ever disagreed with a neighbour or classmate about something small that grew into a bigger problem?

The Fence Between Us

- 1 When the Aydemirs planted a tall hedge along their garden fence, their neighbours, the Karas, were furious. The hedge blocked the afternoon sun from the Karas' vegetable patch, and within a week the two families were barely speaking. Mr Kara left an angry note; Mrs Aydemir replied with an even angrier one. What had started as a small disagreement over a few metres of greenery was quickly turning into a serious conflict between two families who had once shared coffee every weekend.
- 2 Eventually, a mutual friend suggested they invite a local mediator, someone trained to help neighbours sort out exactly this kind of dispute. In their first meeting, the mediator asked each side one simple question: 'What do you actually need, not just what do you want?' It turned out the Karas needed more light for their vegetables, while the Aydemirs needed privacy from a busy street. Once both families understood the other's real reason, the argument suddenly felt much smaller.
- 3 The solution wasn't complicated. The Aydemirs agreed to trim the hedge to waist height, keeping their privacy lower down while letting sunlight reach the vegetable patch. Neither family got exactly what they had first demanded, but both got what they truly needed. Six months later, the Karas and Aydemirs were sharing coffee again — and jokes about the infamous hedge.

221 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- What was the real cause of tension between the two families?
☐ a A disagreement over money ☐ b A hedge that affected light and privacy
☐ c A disagreement about a shared car
 - The families invited a local _____ to help them talk things through.
 - What question did the mediator ask each side?
☐ a Who is right and who is wrong? ☐ b What do you actually need, not just what do you want?
☐ c Who planted the hedge first?
 - According to the text, the Aydemirs completely removed the hedge. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- _____
- Neither family got exactly what they had first demanded, but both got what they truly _____.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

- Why do you think understanding someone's real 'need' (not just their demand) can help resolve a conflict?

- Can you think of a compromise that could solve a disagreement you know about?

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

- What do you think can cause conflict in a group project at school?

- Do you think it's fair to judge someone before hearing their side of the story?

Two Sides of the Story

- When their teacher put Aslı, Burak and two classmates into a group project on renewable energy, nobody expected it to end in an argument. By the second week, Aslı had written most of the report herself, while Burak had missed two planning meetings without much explanation. 'He clearly doesn't care about the grade,' Aslı complained to her friends, refusing to speak to him directly.
- When their teacher noticed the tension, she asked both students to explain their side privately before deciding anything. Burak admitted he had been working extra shifts at his family's shop after

school and had simply lost track of the group's messages. Aslı, meanwhile, admitted she had never actually told him how much extra work she was doing — she had just assumed he knew.

- 3 With their teacher's help, the group redrew the task list, giving Burak a smaller, clearly defined part he could finish around his shifts, and giving Aslı credit for the sections she had already written. Their final presentation on solar energy went smoothly, and afterwards Burak thanked Aslı for not simply reporting him — while Aslı admitted she should have asked, instead of assumed, from the start.

194 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- Why was Aslı frustrated with Burak at first?
☐ a He had copied her work ☐ b He had missed meetings without much explanation
☐ c He had left the group completely
- Burak had been working extra _____ at his family's shop after school.
- Aslı had clearly told Burak how much extra work she was doing. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- What did the teacher do when she noticed the tension?
☐ a She gave the group a lower grade immediately
☐ b She asked both students to explain their side privately ☐ c She removed Burak from the group
- In the end, the group redrew the _____ so that everyone had a fair, clearly defined part.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

- Why did assuming, instead of asking, make the conflict worse?

- What would you have done differently if you were Aslı, from the start?

